

CHAPTER

10

GUILTLESS DESSERT RECIPES

Sweet Treats for a Lean Machine

If you have a sweet tooth and that has been your downfall, then this chapter is for you. This is my problem: All day long I do a great job of following my program, but by evening I'm craving something sweet. My two daughters have pointed this out to me several times. They all have the same craving for sweets late in the day, but they also love these healthy dessert options that are on my program. We make them as a family.

Some of these recipes are even my daughters' concoctions. A very simple, yet healthy dessert option is frozen fruit. My favorite fresh fruits to freeze are grapes and blueberries because biting into them tastes like Italian ice. But, you can freeze any fruit you like. This is a great and easy start for eating healthy desserts, but if you want to expand your dessert options, here are a few of my recipes.

Chocolate Fondue

Ingredients:

1 oz of a 90% or higher dark chocolate bar

1 bowl of fruit (any fruit: strawberries, pineapple, melon, etc.)

Instructions:

1. Melt 1 oz of the chocolate bar in the microwave. Don't melt it all the way because it might burn, melt it $\frac{3}{4}$ of way, which will probably take about 40 seconds on high.
2. Then dip your fruit in it and enjoy a decadent dessert without any guilt. The chocolate has such high fiber that it offsets the moderate amount of sugar. *Serves 1*

Chocolate Protein Pudding

Ingredients:

1 box of sugar-free instant pudding

1 scoop of your favorite plain protein

½ teaspoon of konjac glucomannan powder (optional)

½ cup of the milk of your choice

Instructions:

1. Take the sugar-free instant pudding and add 1 scoop of your protein.
2. Mix it in dry until the protein absorbs into the pudding mix.
3. Add the konjac glucomannan powder to thicken the pudding and add whatever milk you desire. (if you are using almond or rice milk add ½ cup less, or the pudding will have a hard time thickening) *Serves as many as the pudding mix says.*

Banana Ice Cream

Ingredients:

3 frozen bananas

3 tablespoons of your favorite type of milk

2 tablespoons of cocoa nibs (optional)

Instructions:

1. Place the frozen bananas and the milk into a blender.
2. Blend until the mixture looks creamy, about 30 seconds.
3. Fold in the cocoa nibs if you chose to do so, but do not blend them.
4. Empty the mixture into a bread or brownie pan and make sure the mixture is evenly spread across the pan.
5. Freeze for 2 hours. *Serves 3*

Peanut Butter Banana Ice Cream

Ingredients:

3 frozen bananas

3 tablespoons of your favorite type of milk

2 tablespoons of peanut butter

1 tablespoon of cocoa nibs (optional)

Instructions:

1. Place the frozen bananas, milk and peanut butter into a blender.
2. Blend until the mixture looks creamy, about 30 seconds.
3. Empty the mixture into a bread or brownie pan and make sure the mixture is evenly spread across the pan.
3. Freeze for 2 hours.
4. You can additionally add 1 tablespoon of cocoa nibs on top if desired.

Serves 3

Strawberry Ice Cream

Ingredients:

1 cup of frozen strawberries

3 tablespoons of your favorite type of milk

Instructions:

1. Place the frozen strawberries and the milk into a blender.
2. Blend until the mixture looks creamy, about 30 seconds.
3. Empty the mixture into a bread or brownie pan and make sure the mixture is evenly spread across the pan.
3. Freeze for 2 hours. *Serves 1*

Greek Yogurt Smoothie

Ingredients:

1 cup of Greek yogurt

½ cup of ice cubes

½ of a frozen banana

1 cup of any type of fruit you like in your smoothie (I generally add berries such as raspberries, blueberries, strawberries and blackberries, but you can add anything you would like.)

¼ teaspoon of konjac glucomannan powder (optional)

Instructions:

1. Place all the ingredients into a blender.
2. Blend the ingredients for about 30 seconds or until the fruit is completely blended in and there you have a healthy dessert.

Green Smoothie

Ingredients:

1 cup of fresh spinach

¾ cup of water, coconut water or almond milk (It's up to you!)

1 frozen banana

½ cup of pineapple

½ cup of mango, oranges or apples (Again it is up to you!) This smoothie is great because you can mix different ingredients and see what you like best!

Instructions:

1. Put the spinach and the liquid base you chose into a blender and blend the mixture until it turns into a puree.
2. Then, place the rest of the ingredients into the blender and blend for about 30 seconds or until all the fruit is completely blended.

Final Thoughts: More Helpful Tips for Better Results

★ Here are some of my favorite tips for helping you derive even more success from my nutrition program.

1. Brush your teeth after eating. It's hard to have a sweet tooth with a minty taste in your mouth.
2. Chew sugar free gum if it's not your time to eat but you want something in your mouth.
3. Eat slowly. Let your brain realize its full.
4. Keep food away from where you watch TV, studying, working, etc. If you have to go and get food you are much more likely to skip it than if it's right next to you.
5. If you feel hungry, try drinking a glass of water first (I keep banging this water thing home, because it is crucial to attaining your goal).
6. Don't bring junk food home. Do not have food you should not eat in your house.
7. Out of sight, out of mouth. If you must have junk food in your house, then do not have it laying out in a clear container. Keep it out of sight and out of mind.
8. Don't serve food family style. Plate it. Eat it. No seconds.
9. Drink 12 oz of water first thing when you wake up.
10. Never eat at least 2 hours prior to any workout if you plan on burning fat for energy. (Your body might take up to 2 weeks to get used to converting fat quickly for energy, but keep working at it. Most people get used to this in less than a week).

The Ultimate Banana Smoothie

Ingredients:

1 frozen banana

1 ½ cup of ice

½ cup of vanilla almond milk, unsweetened

¼ teaspoon of konjac glucomannan powder

Instructions:

1. Place all the ingredients into a blender.
2. Mix in a high power blender for approximately 45 seconds, or until the smoothie is thick, but still smooth.

Acai Bowl

Ingredients:

1 frozen banana

1 package of unsweetened acai puree packets (You can buy acai berries at Trader Joe's or other specialty grocery stores)

¼ cup of frozen blueberries

¼ cup of frozen blackberries

¼ cup of frozen raspberries

¼ cup of frozen strawberries

½ cup of non-fat milk or unsweetened almond milk

3 tablespoons of granola

1 tablespoon of honey or agave

Instructions:

1. Put the banana, acai berries, blueberries, blackberries, raspberries, strawberries and milk into a blender.
2. Mix the ingredients on high for about 30 seconds or until the fruit is completely blended.
3. Place your mixture into a bowl and add the granola and honey/agave on top.
4. You can add a few berries on top if you would like as well.

Chocolate Covered Fruit

Ingredients:

3 oz of a 90% or higher dark chocolate bar

Any type of fruit. Some of my favorites for this are: strawberries, melon, pineapple and apples, but you could use any type of fruit.

Instructions:

1. Melt the chocolate bar in the microwave for 40 seconds on high. Don't melt it all the way because it might burn; melt it $\frac{3}{4}$ of the way.
2. Then dip your favorite fruit into the chocolate and place it on a plate.
3. Place your chocolate covered fruit into the fridge for about an hour or until the chocolate has fully hardened.



SUPERHERO STORY: THE LAST WORD

You've probably been trying to figure out this whole nutrition Rubik's Cube your entire life. Many of you have gone through several different eating plans and were excited about finally realizing your goal, only to end up disappointed and frustrated when you returned to regular eating patterns. Then you regained the weight you lost and felt even worse than when you started.

To all of you out there with this experience, I share your anguish. I have spent my personal and professional life trying to find the perfect nutrition plan to get your body toned with maximum definition. Once I achieved this program for myself, I perfected it with my clients. Now I am sharing it with you.

As I mentioned earlier, I could make you count calories, but very few people end up doing this successfully for longer than a few days. But when you eat three times a day and leave at least five hours between meals, the human body becomes a fat-burning machine during most of its waking day. Just remember that when it comes to portions, *trust your hand*.

This strategy gives you the leeway to eat a little more if you are still hungry, preventing you from coming to resent your nutrition program after you've hit some "magic" number of calories. Make this program yours by adding innovative choices within your parameters I've explained, enjoy what you are eating, and never allow yourself to feel hungry or deprived. You'll still be able to burn all your excess bodyfat. And, finally, you'll feel comfortable in your own skin and let your true self shine without being self-conscious ever again.

Love your body—you own it!